

The Empower School
Schemes of work



Term 1

Physical Education: Scheme of work

Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop effective verbal and non-verbal communication skills within a team setting.	- Volleyball Rally with a Twist: Focus on clear instructions and callouts. - Tennis Doubles with Strategy: Constant partner dialogue.	Communication during gameplay. Reflection on effective strategies and areas for improvement.	Volleyball Net Tennis Rackets Tennis Balls Scorecards
2	Confidence	Build confidence through skill mastery and self-efficacy.	- Football Dribble Challenge: Dribbling course with progressive difficulty. - Volleyball Skill Circuit: Rotations through skill stations.	Confidence during tasks. Reflection on skill improvements and celebrating personal milestones.	Footballs Cones Stopwatch Volleyballs Skill station setup (nets, targets)

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3	Teamwork	Enhance teamwork through collaborative planning and execution.	- Ultimate Frisbee Collaboration: Inclusive scoring system. - Football Strategy Session: Planning and role assignments before gameplay.	Contributions to team effort. Reflection on teamwork dynamics and collaboration.	Frisbees Football goals Cones Whiteboard/markers for strategy discussions
4	Self-Reflection	Develop self-awareness through performance evaluation and adaptive strategies.	- Tennis Ball Relay: Focus on balance and control. - Frisbee Target Challenge: Technique adjustments based on reflection.	Individual reflections on performance. Adapting techniques after feedback.	Tennis rackets Tennis balls Frisbees Targets (e.g., cones, hoops)
5	Mindfulness	Cultivate focus and awareness during activities, promoting mental clarity and present-moment awareness.	- Bowls with Focus: Deep breathing and slow, mindful movements. - Guided Football Dribble: Awareness of physical sensations while dribbling.	Engagement in mindfulness practices. Reflection on focus and mental clarity during activities.	Bowls (or similar objects) Football cones Stopwatch Mindfulness reflection sheets
6	Reflection	Foster resilience and perseverance	- Rugby Ball Goal Setting: Incremental	Goal-setting reflections. Handling setbacks	Rugby balls Goalposts or cones Tennis

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		through goal setting and evaluating setbacks as opportunities for growth.	challenges for kicking accuracy. - Tennis Rally Challenge: Continuous rallies with reflection.	and perseverance during challenges.	rackets Tennis balls
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Term 1

Forest School: Scheme of work

Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop an understanding of communication through	- Identifying food to forage - Foraging for wild berries	- Observe pupils' ability to discuss and collaborate	Field guides, baskets, cooking utensils, edible

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		collaborative outdoor activities and foraging.	- Campfire cooking: Making a crumble together	effectively. - Assess understanding of safe foraging practices.	plant charts, ingredients for crumbling.
2	Confidence	Build self-confidence by learning new skills, practicing creativity, and working with tools.	- Tool maintenance and responsible tool use - Woodwork - Sketching and designing a wildlife house	- Evaluate skill mastery in tool use. - Observe creativity and articulation in sketches and woodworking.	Tools (saws, hammers, sandpaper), wood, safety gloves, pencils, paper.
3	Teamwork	Strengthen teamwork skills through shared responsibility and collaborative projects.	- Building a wildlife house as a team - Natural shelter building competition in teams	- Assess pupils' ability to plan and collaborate as a group. - Reflect on teamwork dynamics after each activity.	Building materials, ropes, natural resources, instructions for shelters.
4	Self-Reflection	Foster self-awareness and personal growth by engaging in traditional crafts and creative processes.	- Learning traditional crafts - Wood carving/pyro art - Willow weaving basketry - Bamboo lantern making	- Encourage pupils to reflect on their progress and creativity. - Observe patience and self-expression during activities.	Willow, bamboo, carving tools, pyrography kits, basketry supplies.

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5	Mindfulness	Teach mindfulness through engaging, community-oriented, and reflective activities.	- Introduction to mindfulness - Community art project: Seashell mural with clay	- Evaluate students' focus and emotional management during activities. - Reflect on personal contributions to the community.	Clay, seashells, mindfulness worksheets, art supplies.
6	Reflection	Encourage pupils to reflect on their personal growth and learning journey by creating tangible representations of their experiences.	- Creating a tapestry of tales	- Assess how effectively students convey their learning experiences through their artwork. - Foster discussions on personal growth.	Art materials, fabric, thread, natural items for decoration.

Term 2

Physical Education: Scheme of work

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Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop effective verbal and non-verbal communication skills through interactive activities.	- Human Knot Challenge with variations - Relay Races with verbal cues	- Observe team communication strategies. - Assess ability to follow and give clear instructions.	Blindfolds, cones, ropes.
2	Confidence	Build self-confidence by tackling physical challenges and setting personal goals.	- Climbing wall or rope challenge - Basketball trick shots	- Assess progress in meeting personal goals. - Observe peer encouragement and perseverance.	Climbing wall or ropes, basketballs, hoops.
3	Teamwork	Strengthen teamwork skills through group strategy, coordination, and shared responsibilities.	- Tug of War with strategy - Multiball Dodgeball	- Evaluate group strategies and adjustments. - Observe shared responsibilities and active participation.	Tug of war rope, dodgeballs.
4	Self-Reflection	Encourage self-awareness and personal growth by reflecting on individual and peer performance.	- Personal goal journals - Partner skill evaluations	- Evaluate journal reflections on personal growth. - Observe constructive feedback between partners.	Journals, pens, skill evaluation sheets.
5	Mindfulness	Teach mindfulness techniques to enhance focus, emotional regulation, and physical awareness.	- Yoga for athletes - Guided visualization before matches	- Observe students' focus and participation in mindfulness activities. - Assess their ability to relax.	Yoga mats, guided visualization scripts, quiet space.

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6	Reflection	Foster reflection on teamwork, strategies, and personal highlights, emphasizing both strengths and areas for improvement.	- Capture the Flag tournament with feedback - Highlight reel discussions	- Reflect on teamwork and individual contributions. - Share and discuss highlight moments with peers.	Capture the Flag equipment, discussion prompts.
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Term 2

Forest School: Scheme of work

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Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop verbal and non-verbal communication skills by engaging in interactive nature-based activities.	- Nature Charades: Mimic animals or elements of nature. - Building a Sound Map: Identify natural sounds.	- Observe non-verbal communication skills. - Assess descriptive verbal sharing of observations.	Animal flashcards, notebooks, pencils, blindfolds.
2	Confidence	Build confidence by learning essential outdoor skills and taking pride in creating tools from natural materials.	- Learning to Start a Fire Safely: Practice fire-starting techniques. - Creating Simple Tools: Craft tools.	- Evaluate mastery of fire-starting techniques. - Assess creativity and functionality of tools.	Fire-starting kit, safety gloves, wood, carving tools.
3	Teamwork	Enhance teamwork through problem-solving and collaborative creative projects.	- River Crossing Simulation: Plan and execute a simulated river crossing. - Cooperative Nature Sculptures: Build sculptures.	- Observe group collaboration and problem-solving. - Evaluate creativity and shared contributions	Ropes, planks, natural materials (twigs, leaves, rocks).
4	Self-Reflection	Foster introspection and critical thinking by observing nature and documenting	- Tracking Animal Prints: Identify and reflect on animal tracks. - Nature Journaling	- Assess observational skills and journal reflections. - Evaluate critical thinking	Animal print guide, journals, pencils.

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		personal experiences.	with Prompts: Write reflections.	and self-awareness.	
5	Mindfulness	Cultivate mindfulness by engaging in sensory experiences and meditative creative activities in nature.	- Forest Bathing Walks: Focus on sensory awareness during slow walks. - Creating Mandalas: Use natural materials.	- Observe students' ability to focus and stay present. - Evaluate creativity in mandala designs.	Natural materials (stones, leaves, flowers), calming environment.
6	Reflection	Encourage self-expression and goal setting through storytelling and creative visualization activities.	- Sharing Campfire Stories: Reflect and articulate learning experiences. - Creating Vision Boards: Visualize personal goals.	- Assess depth of self-expression in storytelling. - Evaluate the symbolism and thoughtfulness in vision boards.	Campfire, vision board materials (leaves, twigs, glue).

Term 3

Physical Education: Scheme of work

Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
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1	Communication	Develop effective verbal and non-verbal communication skills within a team setting.	- Strategy Tag: Teams strategize and communicate during a dynamic tag game. ula - Hoop Pass Relay: Strengthens verbal and non-verbal communication in a shared goal.	Reflection on communication strategies and teamwork during activities.	Hula hoops, markers for safe zones.
2	Confidence	Build confidence through skill mastery and self-efficacy.	- Obstacle Course Challenge: Encourages conquering physical challenges. - Team Juggling: Builds self-confidence by mastering team coordination skills.	Celebrate individual progress and reflect on achievements.	Obstacle course setup, beanbags/balls.
3	Teamwork	Enhance teamwork through collaborative planning and execution.	- Group Rope Skipping: Teams coordinate timing and rhythm to skip together. - Capture the Cone: Teams collaborate on	Contributions to teamwork and reflections on collaboration and strategy.	Jump ropes, cones.

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			strategy while defending and capturing cones.		
4	Self-Reflection	Develop self-awareness through performance evaluation and adaptive strategies.	- Personal Fitness Tracker: Track fitness task progress over sessions. - Target Practice with Journaling: Reflect on performance and technique through journaling.	Individual reflections on progress and adjustments to strategies.	Fitness trackers, targets, journals.
5	Mindfulness	Promote awareness and focus through physical and reflective activities.	- Nature Walk and Stretching: Combines mindfulness and light activity. - Silent Ball: Cultivates mindfulness through quiet, focused play.	Reflections on feelings, focus, and presence during activities.	Open outdoor space, soft ball.

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6	Reflection	Celebrate achievements and review lessons learned.	- End-of-Term Sports Tournament: Mini tournament encouraging reflection on teamwork and sportsmanship. Personal Highlight Boards: Students showcase achievements and key lessons.	Group discussion on key takeaways and sharing of highlight boards.	Sports equipment, craft materials.
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Term 3

Forest School: Scheme of work

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Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop verbal and non-verbal communication by engaging in interactive, nature-based activities.	- Woodland Map Hunt: Navigate to locate hidden items in teams, reflecting on communication's role. - Web of Connection: Use yarn to create a visual web representing teamwork and communication	Observe and assess verbal and non-verbal communication in team settings.	Maps, markers, a ball of yarn.
2	Confidence	Build confidence by mastering outdoor challenges and expressing creativity with natural materials.	- Log Balancing Challenge: Complete a balancing course with peer support. - Woodland Sculptures: Create and present sculptures made from natural materials to express creativity.	Evaluate persistence and creativity. Reflect on individual confidence growth.	Logs, natural materials for sculptures.
3	Teamwork	Enhance teamwork through collaborative problem-solving and creative tasks.	- Shelter Building: Collaboratively construct a functional shelter from natural materials. - Forest Relay Adventure:	Observe group dynamics, problem-solving skills, and team collaboration.	Natural materials, ropes, containers.

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			Complete multi-task relays emphasizing trust and coordination.		
4	Self-Reflection	Foster introspection and critical thinking by observing nature and documenting personal experiences.	- Nature Journaling: Reflect on personal growth through journaling experiences in nature. - Woodland Target Practice: Adjust techniques and reflect on improvements during target practice.	Assess journal entries and reflective adjustments during activities.	Journals, bows/slingshots, targets.
5	Mindfulness	Cultivate mindfulness through sensory experiences and meditative creative activities in nature.	- Forest Bathing and Guided Meditation: Silent Forest Walk with breathing and meditation exercises. - Silent Woodland Circle: Share observations quietly, focusing on presence and awareness.	Reflect on sensations and emotions experienced during mindfulness activities.	Natural objects, calming environment.

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6	Reflection	Promote positive self-reflection and celebrate achievements through collaborative discussions and tasks.	- Nature Showcase: Present personal highlights and achievements from the term. - End-of-Term Woodland Games: Apply learned skills in a celebratory mini-tournament.	Discuss lessons learned, achievements, and teamwork throughout the term.	Materials for games and presentations.
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Term 4

Physical Education: Scheme of work

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Schemes of work

Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	- Develop verbal and non-verbal communication skills.	- Puzzle Relay: Solve puzzles at relay stations requiring teamwork. Reflect on strategies post-activity. Activity - Build a Shelter Challenge: Teams build a shelter within a set time and discuss approaches.	- Observe how students communicate during activities. - Reflective discussion on strategies and improvements.	Mats, cones, ropes, puzzles/riddles.
2	Confidence	- Build resilience and confidence through physical and adaptive challenges.	- Circuit of Resilience: Complete physical challenges as a team. - Tug of War with a Twist: Compete with team changes and added challenges. Reflect on successes.	- Monitor persistence and encouragement between team members. - Reflective discussion on overcoming challenges.	Balance beams, ropes, markers, stopwatch.
3	Teamwork	- Enhance collaboration, problem-solving, and shared effort in group settings.	Human Knot Challenge: Untangle themselves in a circle using communication. - Multi-Sport Relay: Teams	- Observe team collaboration and problem-solving. - Reflective discussion on teamwork dynamics.	Sports equipment (e.g., balls, cones, goals).

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			complete relays involving different sports activities.		
4	Self-Reflection	- Encourage self-awareness and reflection on progress and skills.	- Skill Mastery Stations: Practice skills like juggling or balancing. Reflect on growth. Activity - Challenge Ladders: Attempt tasks of increasing difficulty.	- Students reflect on personal progress at each station. - Celebrate individual achievements.	Juggling balls, hula hoops, skipping ropes.
5	Mindfulness	- Foster relaxation, presence, and physical connection through mindful activities.	- Partner Stretching and Breathing: Perform stretches in pairs with focus on relaxation. - Movement Meditation: Guide students through slow, deliberate movements.	- Reflective discussion on physical and mental relaxation. - Students describe how mindfulness affected their focus.	Yoga mats, stretch bands, guided breathing scripts.
6	Reflection	- Encourage students to reflect on and celebrate their progress over the term.	- Inter-Year Showcase: Demonstrate skills or lead activities. - Growth Journals: Track personal progress and	- Reflective group discussion on key takeaways. - Review journal entries for individual progress and goals.	Showcase space, journals, pens, group activity props.

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			set future goals.		
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Term 4

Forest School: Scheme of work

Week	Theme	Objectives	Key Activities	Assessment Tasks	Resources Needed
1	Communication	Develop verbal and non-verbal communication skills through teamwork and outdoor challenges.	- Silent Strategy Challenge: Students complete woodland tasks (e.g., setting up	Reflection discussions on communication strategies and effectiveness.	Blindfolds, natural materials for challenges.

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			a shelter, transporting water) using only gestures. Reflection on communication styles follows. - Echo Trail Navigation: Blindfolded students navigate a short trail using only verbal directions from a partner, reflecting on clarity, tone, and trust.		
2	Confidence	Encourage self-expression and build confidence in leadership roles.	- Woodland Trust Walk: One student leads a blindfolded partner through a natural obstacle course to build confidence in leadership and trust. - Nature's Stage – Outdoor Storytelling: Students create and perform nature-based stories, developing	Observation of leadership and storytelling engagement.	Blindfolds, natural stage setting.

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			public speaking skills.		
3	Teamwork	Reinforce teamwork through problem-solving and shared leadership.	- Web of Support Challenge: Teams navigate a rope "spider web" without touching the ropes, emphasizing trust and collaboration. - Cooperative Shelter Building: Teams design and build a functional woodland shelter, later reflecting on their teamwork strategies.	Peer and self-reflections on teamwork effectiveness.	Ropes, woodland materials.
4	Self-Reflection	Foster personal awareness and deep thinking in a natural setting.	- Solo Sit Spot: Students spend 20 minutes alone reflecting on their connection to nature, followed by journaling. - Journey Stick Storytelling: Students collect items during a walk and attach	Written journals and storytelling presentations.	Journals, journey sticks, natural materials.

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			them to a journey stick, symbolizing key moments in their learning journey.		
5	Mindfulness	Enhance sensory awareness and creativity through nature-based mindfulness.	- Sound Map Exploration: Students sit quietly and map the different sounds they hear, reflecting on their mindfulness. - Woodland Mandala Creation: Students collect natural materials to create collaborative mandalas, discussing the experience afterward.	Reflection discussions on mindfulness experiences.	Paper, pens, natural materials.
6	Reflection	Celebrate achievements and set future learning goals.	- Forest Feast Celebration: Students prepare a simple feast using outdoor cooking skills and share reflections on their learning. - Personal Growth Ceremony:	Student self-assessment and group reflection circle.	Cooking materials, certificates, tokens.

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			Students receive certificates or tokens and share personal highlights in a reflective circle.		
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All terms: Scheme of work

Reasonable Adjustments for Physical Education and Forest School

Week	Theme	TA Support & Other Areas	Clothing Adjustments	Engaging Girls & SEND Needs	Adaptations for Disabilities & SEMH
1	Communication	TA to facilitate peer communication, model teamwork, and use visual prompts.	Allow students to wear their own comfortable clothing if needed.	Mixed-gender teams; allow verbal and non-verbal participation; use small-group discussions.	Alternative ways to communicate (e.g., sign language, visual aids); adjust pace for anxiety.

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2	Confidence	TA to provide encouragement, modify tasks for accessibility.	Option for sensory-friendly clothing (e.g., no restrictive sports gear).	Set personal rather than competitive goals; choice-based participation.	Smaller group settings; alternative equipment (e.g., lighter balls, stability supports).
3	Teamwork	TA to support planning, role allocation, and social interactions.	Flexible clothing policy for comfort.	Peer mentoring and buddy system; cooperative rather than competitive activities.	Structured roles with clear instructions; provide rest breaks.
4	Self-Reflection	TA to guide discussions and provide differentiated reflection tools (e.g., visual charts).	Sensory-friendly layers (avoid overheating/cold discomfort).	Encourage self-expression (verbal or written options); role models for female participation.	Break reflection into smaller prompts; one-to-one discussion option.
5	Mindfulness	TA to guide relaxation techniques and ensure emotional safety.	Encourage loose, comfortable clothing for relaxation exercises.	Create a calm and inclusive space; introduce mindfulness through storytelling.	Adapt breathing exercises (e.g., tactile breathing using objects); noise-reducing headphones.
6	Reflection	TA to support self-assessment and scaffold responses.	Flexible dress code for the final activity.	Celebrate all progress, not just performance; peer recognition.	Visual progress trackers; video/audio options for non-verbal students.

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